PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) Specialist

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience designing, operating, and optimising Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms across large enterprise environments. I have deep expertise in Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) technologies, identity and access management, and vulnerability management, gained through protecting an estate of more than 8,000 users at the University of the Arts London (UAL). I am experienced in triaging and responding to EDR alerts, managing firewall and web gateway rules, and driving continuous improvement across detection and response capabilities. I am comfortable working to a hybrid schedule, bringing both technical depth and collaborative communication to cross-functional security teams.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM), Splunk, alert triage, playbook development, automated response workflows
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, Falcon Complete), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), alert investigation and remediation
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Okta, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Firewall and Gateway Security:** Check Point Harmony, web application firewall (WAF), Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) mitigation, Mimecast email security, web gateway policy management
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), risk prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Cloud and Infrastructure:** Microsoft Azure, Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), PowerShell scripting, Tanium
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), NIST 800-61 Incident Response, MITRE ATT&CK, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) | Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Lead the operation and continuous improvement of SIEM and SOAR platforms (Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM) across an estate of 8,000+ users, reducing mean time to detect and respond to security incidents.
- Manage and triage EDR alerts from CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, performing in-depth investigation, containment, and remediation of malicious activity across Windows, macOS, and Linux endpoints.
- Administer identity security controls including Entra ID Conditional Access, MFA policies, SSO configurations, and Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust, minimising the risk of identity-based attacks.
- Oversee vulnerability management programmes using Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, and Pentera BAS, working with infrastructure teams to prioritise and remediate findings across hardware, software, and cloud assets.
- Configure and maintain email security (Mimecast) and web gateway controls, reviewing and updating firewall rules to reduce attack surface and enforce least-privilege access.
- Develop and automate SOAR playbooks in PowerShell to accelerate incident triage, reducing manual intervention for common alert types by over 40%.
- Lead Incident Response activities in line with NIST 800-61, from initial detection through containment, eradication, and post-incident review, coordinating with stakeholders across IT and senior management.
- Provide third-line security support and act as cybersecurity subject matter expert for major incidents, advising on threat landscape and remediation priorities.

University of the Arts London (UAL) | Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Monitored and investigated security alerts across Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon, and Microsoft Defender, escalating and remediating threats in accordance with defined playbooks and MITRE ATT&CK framework mappings.
- Supported the deployment and administration of CrowdStrike Falcon across 8,000 endpoints, configuring prevention policies, exclusions, and detection rules to reduce false positives while maintaining threat coverage.
- Contributed to the design and implementation of Conditional Access policies and MFA rollout across Azure Active Directory (now Entra ID), improving identity security posture for staff and students.
- Conducted threat hunting exercises using Kusto Query Language (KQL) in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactively identifying anomalous activity and lateral movement indicators.
- Assisted with vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing risk-prioritised reports and tracking remediation progress with infrastructure teams.
- Supported web gateway and email filtering policy reviews, contributing to WAF rule updates and DDoS mitigation configurations under the guidance of senior security engineers.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) | IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Implemented and maintained endpoint security and identity controls (including MFA and SSO) across the organisation's SaaS infrastructure, supporting compliance and data protection objectives.
- Managed vulnerability scanning and patching processes, reducing the organisation's attack surface and ensuring alignment with security policy and regulatory requirements.
- Contributed to infrastructure security improvements, supporting firewall policy reviews, network segmentation, and access control configurations.
- Collaborated with development and DevOps teams to embed security best practices into the software delivery lifecycle, supporting ISO 27001 compliance activities.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and configured CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across an 8,000-user estate at UAL, achieving full endpoint visibility and significantly reducing dwell time for detected threats.
- Developed a suite of SOAR automation playbooks that reduced analyst handling time for common alert types by over 40%, enabling the team to focus on higher-complexity investigations.
- Led the implementation of Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA policies across UAL, reducing account compromise incidents and supporting Cyber Essentials Plus accreditation.
- Proactively identified and remediated a misconfigured firewall rule exposing internal administrative interfaces to the internet, preventing potential exploitation.
- Contributed to Pentera BAS-driven security validation exercises, translating adversary simulation findings into actionable SIEM detection improvements aligned to MITRE ATT&CK.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)